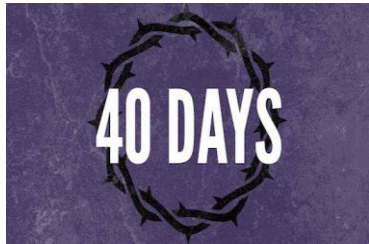


LIVING SAVIOR FEBRUARY, MARCH, APRIL 2021
NEWSLETTER
WORSHIP & MUSIC

"40 Days in . . . 40 Days of?"



It's that time of the year again. We have come through the post-Christmas time known as Epiphany and we're moving into Spring . . . oops! I meant to say Lent. Lent . . . that 40-day period when we remember when we remember the solemn events in the life of Jesus. Have you ever taken the time to reflect upon the significance of the number 40 in the Bible? How often does it appear? Noah and the flood – 40 days and nights; Moses' life – 40 years in Egypt, 40 years being prepared by God, 40 years leading the Children of Israel; Jesus – 40 days in the wilderness; 40 days following his resurrection prior to his ascension. 40 day periods are significant in the Bible and in the life of the Church as we think about the season of Lent.

Do the math. Look at Ash Wednesday and count the number of days until Easter. You will quickly discover that there are more than 40 days. This is not a mistake. In establishing a "Church Year" and liturgical calendar, the early Church leaders were wise not to include Sundays in counting the number of days in Lent. It was intentional. This helps all of us to remember that even as we move through the season of Lent, we think of the Sundays IN Lent as opposed to the Sundays OF Lent.

What's the difference? The difference is the theology of the resurrection. Every Sunday, whether we gather in Advent, Epiphany or any other season of the Church Year, is always a celebration and remembrance of Jesus' resurrection. It is a "Little Easter." It is that celebration that shapes who we are and how we worship.

One of the hallmarks of our Lutheran tradition is that people leave worship having heard the hope of the Gospel. We do not depart searching for the answer. Rather, we recognize that our hope is

always in the resurrection. It is that reality that shapes who we are as Christians. Living in that reality helps us to celebrate and observe the Sundays in Lent rather than focusing upon a Sunday of Lent.

We have 40 other days to reflect upon the Lenten disciplines and practices. Those parts of our Lenten observances are good. They are necessary. We have wonderful opportunities to experience those Lenten traditions. Mid-week Lenten services are a good example. As we experience the 40 days of Lent, we can then gather on the Sundays in Lent to remember, celebrate, and apply to our lives what Christ has done for us through His Easter victory.

MID-WEEK LENTEN SERVICES

The Lenten season begins on Ash Wednesday, February 17. We will observe Lent with mid-week service on Wednesdays at 7:00 P.M. The sermon series this year will be "What Makes You Sweat?" based upon Luke 22:44.

SUNDAY NIGHT BIBLE STUDY

Dr Benson and I continue to lead our Sunday night Bible study based upon the book, The Good and Beautiful God, by James Bryan Smith. Each session is from 6;30 P.M. to 8:00 P.M. If you would like to be a part of this study, please email Dr. Benson at mabenson2@gmail.com and she will send you a zoom link and further information.

Dr. Wallach Horton, Minister of Worship & Music